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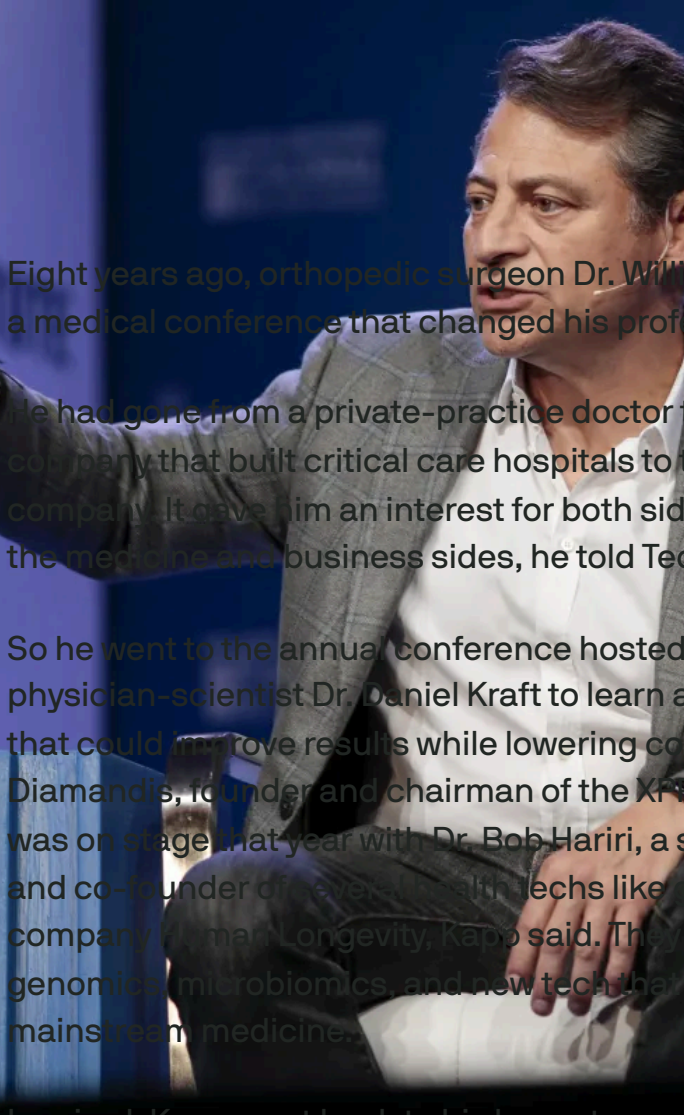
IQ: 155



VENTURE



Tony Robbins and Peter Diamandis' longevity company Fountain Life raises \$18M



Eight years ago, orthopedic surgeon Dr. William Kapp attended a medical conference that changed his professional life.

He had gone from a private-practice doctor to co-founding a company that built critical care hospitals to then selling that company. It gave him an interest for both sides of healthcare: the medicine and business sides, he told TechCrunch.

So he went to the annual conference hosted by famed physician-scientist Dr. Daniel Kraft to learn about new tech that could improve results while lowering costs. Dr. Peter Diamandis, founder and chairman of the XPRIZE Foundation, was on stage that year with Dr. Bob Hariri, a stem-cell pioneer and co-founder of several health techs like genomics company Human Longevity, Kapp said. They discussed genomics, microbiomics, and new tech that wasn't part of mainstream medicine.

Inspired, Kapp went back to his home town of Naples, Florida, and "started a thing called Longevity Performance Center. The idea was to do early detection and then optimization of people's health," he said.

In March 2020, Diamandis (pictured above) and his buddy Tony Robbins heard of Kapp's center and visited. They had a stem cell startup called Fountain Therapeutics. Conversation soon turned toward a merger, and by October that year, the two companies became [Fountain Life](#).

Kapp remained CEO with both Diamandis and Robbins as his co-founders and board members.

Today his board also includes Hariri as an adviser; Todd Wanek, CEO of Ashley Furniture Industries, as an investor; and wealthy Indian business mogul B.K. Modi as an investor as well.

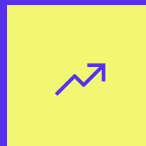
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Fountain Life tells TechCrunch exclusively that it just raised an \$18 million Series B, led by EOS Ventures, with participation from most of the existing members of the board. Fountain previously raised an \$80 million Series A and has raised about \$108 million total, Kapp said.

Longevity as a subject of serious study by the medical community is a new field. When Kapp (pictured below) first launched his center, “We didn’t know exactly what longevity meant,” he said. But over the last four or five years, much more research has been done.

The first principle of longevity, he said, is “don’t die of anything stupid.” Therefore, Fountain Life’s centers, of which there are four today, have a heavy focus on prevention screening, looking for illnesses and chronic conditions at their earliest stages when they tend to be asymptomatic. Blood tests and body scans gather data on over 100 biomarkers, from liver fat to “microbiome concentrations,” he said.

The second principal is optimization, meaning improving those markers with scientifically validated treatments, he said. And the third principal is “using the latest regenerative therapies under FDA trials,” to treat illness or achieve optimization.

Screening tests may discover, for example, small intestinal bacterial overgrowth (SIBO), which, left untreated, may lead to certain cancers, he said. The solution, if caught early, is to restore microbiome balance with specific, prescribed probiotics.

For Fountain’s members, testing is repeated every quarter or so, and patients can track results and ask questions of an AI-powered app called Zori.



DR. WILLIAM KAPP IMAGE CREDITS: FOUNTAIN LIFE

But it's pricey, Kapp admitted. A full subscription costs \$21,500 a year, which covers a barrage of tests and access to a physician but doesn't cover extended medical care. For \$10,500, a patient can get just the testing

process and AI, but not ongoing tests and medical support.

Still, Kapp remembers two stories that told him this work was on the right track. The wife of a Robbins fan bought a membership for her husband, and the tests caught early-stage, asymptomatic kidney cancer. The husband is now cancer-free.

When global hotelier Sam Nazarian was exploring a partnership with Fountain to [put longevity centers in luxury hotels](#), Nazarian did Fountain's tests and found a brain aneurysm. They successfully treated it, Nazarian has [publicly said](#).

Kapp says the new funding will allow the company to open more centers. In addition to Naples, they opened facilities in Orlando, Dallas, and Westchester, New York; a center in Houston will open in December. Centers in Los Angeles and Miami are planned for Q2 of 2026.

He hopes to solve the affordability issue by working on "clinic development" where Fountain trains medical facilities on its methodologies. Kapp says that as the tech and expertise become more widely available, this will drive down costs for access.

Fountain is not the only doctor-driven longevity testing startup. Famed functional health doctor Mark Hyman has a company called [Function Health](#). It offers a package of about 160 blood tests, with follow-up tests every three to six months, for a \$500/year membership (with additional fees for additional blood tests). Its platform similarly analyzes and

tracks test results, although it doesn't include access to physicians. That price doesn't include full body scans but in May Function [acquired](#) a body-scan company called Ezra and now, for an additional fee starting at \$499, offers scans as well.

Correction: Fountain has clarified the price of the annual subscription and that information has been updated. Function has clarified that its body scan technology is available for additional fees and that information has been updated.

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Julie Bort

Venture Editor |

Julie Bort is the Startups/Venture Desk editor for TechCrunch.

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STARTUPS



AI crawler Firecrawl raises \$14.5M, is still looking to



hire agents as employees

Julie Bort — 4:00 AM PDT · August 19, 2025

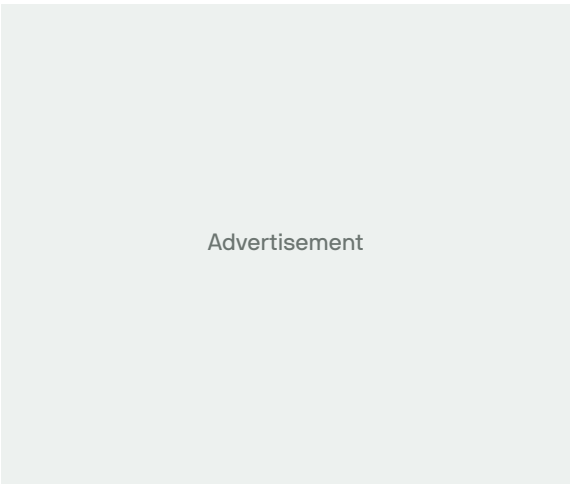
Firecrawl's co-founder and CEO Caleb Pfeffer knew the exact moment he found the right partner to lead his Series A.

He was in a coffee meeting with Nexus Venture Partner's Abhishek Sharma at the Blue Bottle in San Francisco's South Park (a favorite VC haunt). While describing the future of the company, he was gesturing so animatedly that his chair tipped over.

"I actually fell out of my chair. And Abhishek, as a great investor does, caught the chair and me as I was falling," Pfeffer described with a laugh. That felt like a symbol for how the founder/investor relationship is supposed to work. "I think that was a clear signal that he was the right partner."

On Tuesday, Firecrawl announced a Series A led by Nexus with participation from Shopify CEO Tobias Lütke and existing investor Y Combinator.

Firecrawl offers a popular open-source web crawler for developers and AI agents, with a commercially supported version available through API. It's used by 350,000 developers,



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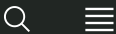


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They landed him through a gutsy email after discovering the Shopify founder had signed up to try their product through their self-service portal.

“We saw his email come in,” Peffer said. The Firecrawl crew immediately emailed him to welcome him as a customer, but got no response. Two months later, some Shopify folks contacted Firecrawl for an enterprise contract. So Peffer took his shot and emailed Lütke again, mentioning they'd love for him to participate in their upcoming round.

This time, Lütke responded with compliments about their product. He was in.

While AI web crawlers have [a somewhat dubious reputation these days](#), mostly due to bad actors [that ignore robot.txt files](#), they are also a necessary part of the burgeoning AI world. AI trains on the web, [agents need to access web pages to perform their duties](#), and enterprises need personalized crawlers to consume their own websites for training and operations.

The Firecrawl founders also hope to help address the frustrating parts of their industry. They are working on tools to help website owners, publishers, and other content creators “get paid when AI uses their content. We think this is the way it should be,” Peffer said.

While there have been lots of efforts around this idea from big names like [Adobe and Getty](#) as well as startups [like Bria](#),

[Calliope Networks](#), and others, Peffer feels that Firecrawl has an edge because it's already working with those who are scraping data.

“We already have one side of the marketplace,” he said. “What we want to do is just connect that side of the marketplace to the website owners, the publishers.”

Interestingly, Firecrawl also went viral a few months ago for reasons that have little to do with their open source tool. They had posted an [ad to the YC job board looking to hire an AI agent as an employee for a \\$15,000 salary](#) – perhaps the first job ad for an agent employee, ever.

That job search didn't yield an agent worth hiring, so Firecrawled upped the budget to up [\\$1 million to hire several agents and the developers who built them, and tried again](#). Applicants flooded in, Peffer said, but the company hasn't yet hired any. The founders realized that evaluating and managing wanna-be agent employees is a job in itself. So now they are looking for an AI chief of staff.

Firecrawl's Peffer will [be on stage at Disrupt in October](#) to discuss all that he's learned in a session that covers the pros and cons of hiring AI agents as early employees.

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Julie Bort is the Startups/Venture Desk editor for TechCrunch.

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Pixel 10, AI capabilities, and everything else we expect out of the Made by Google 2025 event

Lauren Forristal — 9:30 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

As anticipation builds for the [Made by Google 2025 event](#), there's a buzz around the Pixel 10 series, arriving notably before the [iPhone 17](#). Apple's [hardware event](#) is expected to take place in September.

The tech giant has made its intentions clear to grow the Pixel line, likely incorporating more generative AI capabilities with Gemini. Made by Google starts at 10 a.m. PT on Wednesday.

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Made by Google 2025: How to watch Google debut the Pixel 10, Pixel Watch 4, and more

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IMAGE CREDITS: THOMAS FULLER/SOPA IMAGES/LIGHTROCKET / GETTY IMAGES

Google already dropped several AI-related updates at its [developer conference](#) in May, but the company will likely demonstrate more Gemini features during the Pixel 10 event. In a recent [YouTube video](#) promoting the new devices, Google even seemed to poke fun at Apple's failed promises with Apple Intelligence advancements on the iPhone.

[Rumors](#) are buzzing about a feature called "Camera Coach," which would let Gemini give you real-time tips for taking better photos. The AI is supposedly able to see what's going on and suggest the best angles and lighting for your shot.

There's also talk of a [conversational photo editing tool](#), where you tell Gemini what you want to tweak in a photo, such as increasing the brightness, removing objects, or changing the background.

Google Pixel 10 | Soon



Pixel 10, 10 Pro, and 10 Pro XL

The standard Pixel 10 phone is expected to undergo significant changes, particularly with the addition of a dedicated telephoto lens, a feature that was previously exclusive to the Pro models. Following the leak of renders showcasing the third rear lens, [Google released a teaser for the Pixel 10](#), confirming the substantial camera upgrade.

Additionally, all phones in the lineup are expected to be powered by a new Tensor G5 processor, ushering in the Gemini era and enhancing performance and power efficiency compared to the Tensor G4 chip.



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IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Aside from these updates, not many obvious changes appear to be on the table. The basic design of the phones will likely remain similar to that of the Pixel 9 series. The displays are also expected to stay the same, with the Pixel 10 and Pixel 10 Pro

featuring a 6.3-inch display, and the Pixel 10 Pro XL with a larger 6.8-inch display.

Some areas where the Pro models may see improvement are camera and video quality, along with battery size, which could allow for faster charging and could address the longevity gap between Pixel and flagship phones from Apple and Samsung.

Plus, there is talk that the Pixel 10 series could support [Qi2 wireless charging](#). If true, this means it would be one of the few Android phones to work with magnetic accessories, such as chargers, wallets, and mounts. Google is also reportedly launching a “Pixelsnap” phone case with a magnetic ring in the center.

Pixel 10 Pro Fold

As for Google’s upcoming foldable, there are rumors suggesting it’ll have a larger cover display, measuring at around 6.4 inches, alongside an 8-inch main screen. Additionally, Google is reportedly enhancing the strength of the hinge, and the bezels are expected to be thinner for a sleek appearance.

Another exciting rumor is the possibility of an [IP68 rating](#), a first for the device. (And according to leaked specs, [this may in fact be coming](#).) This means it can stand up to both dust and water, whereas the Pixel 9 Pro Fold has zero dust protection.

... pic.twitter.com/iJdzbRaDgK

— Evan Blass (@evleaks) [August 7, 2025](#)

Like the other Pixel 10 phones, the Pro Fold will likely be powered by the new G5 chip and include the latest Gemini AI features. The camera system might also receive improvements, potentially featuring a 48-megapixel ultra-wide lens and a telephoto lens with 5x optical zoom. The phone should also likely get a bump in battery life.

The Pixel 10 may come in Moonstone and Jade colors.

The Pixel Watch and Pixel Buds

IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Wearables will also get their time to shine at Google's event, with the Pixel Watch 4 rumored to get a thicker design, a longer battery life, and smaller bezels.

There's also a strong likelihood that the smartwatch will introduce new health and fitness-tracking capabilities, possibly including an upgraded [blood oxygen \(SpO2\) monitoring](#) function.

[Leaks](#) of the Pixel Buds 2a indicate that the earbuds will come in new colors (Fog Light, Hazel, Iris, and Strawberry) along with [features](#) like active noise cancellation. The Pixel Buds Pro 2 will also reportedly come in a new Sterling color.

This story has been updated to include additional rumors.

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Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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